

Blood Pressure Lifestyle Checklist

Evidence-based, non-medication steps to support healthy blood pressure

NUTRITION

- ☐ **Follow a DASH-style eating pattern**
Fruits, vegetables, whole grains, lean protein; associated with an 8-14 mmHg drop in systolic BP
- ☐ **Limit sodium to under 2,300mg/day**
Each 1g reduction in daily sodium is linked to roughly a 2-3 mmHg decrease
- ☐ **Prioritize potassium-rich foods**
Bananas, spinach, potatoes, beans; potassium helps blunt sodium's effect on BP
- ☐ **Limit alcohol to 1 drink/day (women), 2 (men)**
Excess alcohol raises blood pressure in a dose-dependent manner

MOVEMENT

- ☐ **150 minutes of moderate aerobic exercise weekly**
Regular aerobic activity lowers systolic BP by roughly 5-8 mmHg on average
- ☐ **Add 2 sessions of resistance training**
Complements aerobic exercise for long-term vascular health
- ☐ **Break up sitting every 30-60 minutes**
Prolonged sitting is independently associated with higher blood pressure
- ☐ **Maintain a healthy waist circumference**
Roughly 4.5kg of weight loss can lower systolic BP by about 4-5 mmHg

MONITORING & LIFESTYLE

- ☐ **Track blood pressure at home, same time daily**
Home readings are often more predictive of cardiovascular risk than single clinic readings
- ☐ **Prioritize 7-9 hours of sleep per night**
Short sleep duration is consistently linked to elevated hypertension risk
- ☐ **Manage chronic stress with a daily practice**
Sustained cortisol elevation contributes to long-term blood pressure increases
- ☐ **Recheck readings before adjusting any medication**
Never change a prescribed regimen without discussing readings with a physician

This checklist is educational and not a substitute for medical advice. Consult a physician before making changes if you take blood pressure medication.